

Remote and Hybrid Work Policy

Document ID: DOC-002

Effective Date: February 1, 2024

Last Revised: September 1, 2024

Owner: Global People & Workplace Experience

Applicability: All Global Employees

1. Purpose and Guiding Principles

Quantic Global Enterprises supports flexible working arrangements designed to foster high performance, employee engagement, and inclusive collaboration. This policy outlines the eligibility criteria, expectations, approval processes, and compliance requirements governing remote and hybrid work arrangements.

2. Remote Work Eligibility Criteria

Remote and hybrid work arrangements are a privilege and operational arrangement, not a universal contractual right. Eligibility is evaluated objectively based on four mandatory baseline criteria:

2.1 Employment Type Requirement

Only regular, permanent full-time employees are eligible to apply for formal remote or hybrid work agreements.

- Regular full-time staff who have completed their introductory onboarding period may apply.
- Part-time employees, temporary employees, student interns, and independent contractors are strictly ineligible for permanent remote work classifications.

2.2 Minimum Continuous Tenure Threshold

Employees must possess a minimum of six (6) whole months of continuous service with the company before submitting a remote work application. This ensures sufficient time for the employee to assimilate into company culture, establish baseline team workflows, and demonstrate consistent performance competency.

2.3 Role Compatibility and Operational Feasibility

The employee's job responsibilities must be operationally capable of being executed remotely with full efficacy.

- Eligible Roles: Roles in Software Engineering, Architecture, Product Management, Data Engineering, Quality Assurance, HR People Operations, Finance Analysis, and Legal/Compliance are pre-approved as remote-compatible.
- Ineligible Roles: Roles that require on-site physical presence, direct hardware interaction, or physical facility maintenance -- such as Workplace Operations Specialists, Facilities Coordinators, On-site IT Depot Specialists, and Mail/Logistics Staff -- are strictly non-remote roles.

2.4 Performance and Disciplinary Standing

An employee must maintain a record of satisfactory performance. Employees currently subject to a formal Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) or who have received a written disciplinary notice within the preceding twelve (12) months are ineligible for remote work until achieving sustained satisfactory evaluation.

3. Work Arrangement Tiers

3.1 Fully Remote Arrangement (100% Remote)

- Definition: The employee performs 100% of their duties from an approved remote home office location within authorized payroll tax jurisdictions.
- Requirements: Requires department Vice President (VP) written approval, HR People Partner validation, and IT security sign-off. The employee may be required to attend on-site all-hands gatherings up to four (4) times per calendar year with travel expenses covered by the company.

3.2 Hybrid Arrangement (2 to 3 Days In-Office)

- Definition: The employee splits their working hours between an assigned corporate office location and their home office, attending the office at least two designated anchor days per week.
- Requirements: Requires direct department manager approval and registration with Workplace Operations.

3.3 Partial Eligibility Determination

If an employee meets role compatibility and performance criteria but falls short on tenure (e.g., tenure between 3 and 5 months), the employee is classified as partially eligible. Partially eligible employees may be granted a temporary hybrid arrangement of up to one (1) remote day per week at manager discretion, pending completion of the full six-month service milestone.

4. Application and Approval Workflow

To apply for a formal remote or hybrid work arrangement, employees must follow these numbered steps:

1. Self-Assessment: Review Section 2 eligibility criteria (employment type, tenure $\geq$ 6 months, role compatibility, performance standing).
2. Manager Consultation: Discuss remote schedule expectations and core working hours with the direct supervisor.
3. Formal Submission: Submit a "Remote Work Agreement Request" ticket via the HR Employee Portal including home office location details.
4. Compliance & IT Verification: HR People Operations verifies tenure and tax jurisdiction; IT reviews network and device security standards.
5. Final Executive Sign-Off: For fully remote requests, the Department VP reviews and executes the formal agreement.

5. Documented Exceptions and Appeals Process

5.1 Hardship and Relocation Exceptions

Exceptions to the 6-month tenure requirement or geographic criteria may be considered under documented exceptional circumstances:

- Military Spousal Orders: Active military relocation of a spouse or partner.
- Medical Accommodation: Qualified medical conditions approved through the interactive ADA accommodation process.
- Critical Family Hardship: Acute family care obligations documented with HR Benefits.

Exception requests must be submitted in writing to the HR People Operations Director with supporting documentation.

5.2 Appeals Process for Denied Applications

If a remote work application is denied, the employee has the right to appeal the decision:

1. The employee must file a formal written appeal within fourteen (14) calendar days of receiving the denial notice.
2. The appeal must state the specific grounds for reconsideration, addressing each unfulfilled criterion.
3. The HR Appeals Committee (consisting of the Chief People Officer and an impartial VP) will review the case and render a final, binding written determination within ten (10) business days.

6. Workspace, Security, and Compliance Obligations

Remote employees must adhere to all information security standards outlined in the IT Acceptable Use Policy (DOC-007). All company work must be conducted on encrypted corporate-managed hardware. Conducting confidential work over unsecured public Wi-Fi networks without an approved VPN is strictly prohibited.